

Round 3 — “The Investigation”

11:00 PM – Midnight

Scene: Hard evidence. Investigation by conversation. Press the alibis. Look at the body. Open bags. Two visual climaxes anchor the round (the five browns, then Val cleared / Marco’s eyewitness moment) — these are run by characters in the room, not by the host.

- You’re holding three of the round’s load-bearing props. Surface them when the conversation calls for them.
 - **The coffee tin** (when the shirt collar comes up): Open it. Pour out brown powder — wrong texture, wrong smell. *“This was on Mrs. Volkov’s cart. Labeled coffee. Isn’t coffee. Same brown as the collar.”*
 - **The cotton ball + needle cap** (when the autopsy comes up): *“Found these three feet from the basket and ten feet down the corridor. Whoever did this stood right there.”*
- **Seek out:** Rosa (she should see the work order before anyone else), Irina (you hate that she’s tangled in this — but the tin is on her cart).

Your moment to drive — Val cleared (first half of the eyewitness beat)

When Val is cornered on the override card and the room turns on her, step in. Hand over the maintenance work order:

- *“I pulled this from the work-order log. Ms. Montecito signed it at 10:05. Leaking unit on Floor 3. The override card was a maintenance call. She didn’t see Ms. Rathbone.”*
- Then turn to the room and announce: *“Val Montecito is cleared.”*

Marco then drives the second half — the eyewitness moment. Stand back. Let him land it.